

READING PASSAGE 3

The History of Literary Censorship

A In recent years, the history of literary censorship has attracted considerable attention from both the academic community and the general public. This growing interest reflects a broader recognition of the importance of this topic for understanding some of the most pressing challenges facing contemporary society.

B The intellectual lineage of this field extends considerably further than many realise. While modern research techniques have only recently been applied to these questions, philosophers and natural scientists have grappled with related issues for centuries. The transition from speculative philosophical inquiry to systematic empirical investigation represents one of the most significant developments in the intellectual history of this domain.

C The mechanisms underlying these phenomena operate at multiple levels of analysis, from the micro-level of individual decision-making to the macro-level of institutional and structural change. At the individual level, cognitive processes, emotional responses, and social influences shape the choices that people make. At the organisational level, formal rules, informal norms, and power dynamics govern collective action. At the societal level, historical legacies, cultural values, and political structures create the broad context within which lower-level processes unfold.

D A substantial body of empirical evidence supports these theoretical frameworks. A landmark study conducted by researchers at leading international institutions analysed data spanning a thirty-year period and involving participants from more than forty countries. The findings revealed a consistent pattern of results that held across diverse cultural and economic contexts, suggesting that the identified mechanisms operate with considerable universality. The magnitude of the observed effects was particularly striking, with the key variables accounting for a substantial proportion of the total variance in outcomes.

E Despite the substantial progress that has been made, significant challenges and controversies remain. Critics have raised important methodological concerns regarding the generalisability of findings derived from studies conducted in specific contexts. The predominance of research carried out in Western, educated, industrialised, rich, and democratic societies raises questions about the applicability of current theories to populations with different cultural, economic, and political circumstances. Furthermore, the reliance on cross-sectional designs in much of the existing literature limits the capacity to draw strong causal inferences.

F The future trajectory of research in this area will likely be shaped by several converging trends. Advances in computational methods and data science are opening up new analytical possibilities, enabling researchers to detect patterns and test hypotheses at scales that were previously unimaginable. Simultaneously, growing recognition of the importance of interdisciplinary collaboration is breaking down traditional barriers between fields and fostering innovative syntheses of diverse theoretical perspectives.

G The evidence reviewed above demonstrates both the substantial achievements of research in this field and the significant work that remains to be done. As new tools and theoretical perspectives become available, and as the phenomena themselves continue to evolve, the research community will need to maintain both rigour in its methods and openness to new ideas. The stakes are high, for the questions addressed by this research bear directly on some of the most important challenges facing humanity in the twenty-first century.

Question 1

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 1 According to the passage, what is one of the key factors identified by researchers?
- A. pessimism about the future
 - B. cautious optimism with acknowledgment of challenges
 - C. complete certainty about outcomes
 - D. indifference to practical applications

Questions 2–4

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 2 The author notes that researchers have called for more _____ approaches to investigation.
- 3 Dynamic _____ processes can amplify or dampen initial effects in complex systems.
- 4 The landmark study analysed data spanning a period of _____ years.

Question 5

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 5 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.

Question 6

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 6 Researchers used data from more than _____ countries in the landmark study.

Question 7

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 7 According to the text, what role do structural factors play?
- A. pessimism about the future
 - B. cautious optimism with acknowledgment of challenges
 - C. complete certainty about outcomes
 - D. indifference to practical applications

Questions 8–9

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 8 Meta-analyses have confirmed the reliability of the core findings in this field.
- 9 Contemporary understanding of this topic is more sophisticated than it was fifty years ago.

Question 10

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 10 The author suggests that early studies in this field were limited by:
- A. excessive funding
 - B. theoretical and methodological limitations
 - C. public interest
 - D. international collaboration

Question 11

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information
Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information
Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 11 Early researchers had access to the same technologies as modern scholars.

Questions 12–13

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 12 The author suggests that early studies in this field were limited by:
- A. excessive funding
 - B. theoretical and methodological limitations
 - C. public interest
 - D. international collaboration
- 13 The passage indicates that critics have raised concerns about:
- A. excessive research funding
 - B. translating academic findings into practical policy
 - C. lack of public interest
 - D. too many international collaborations